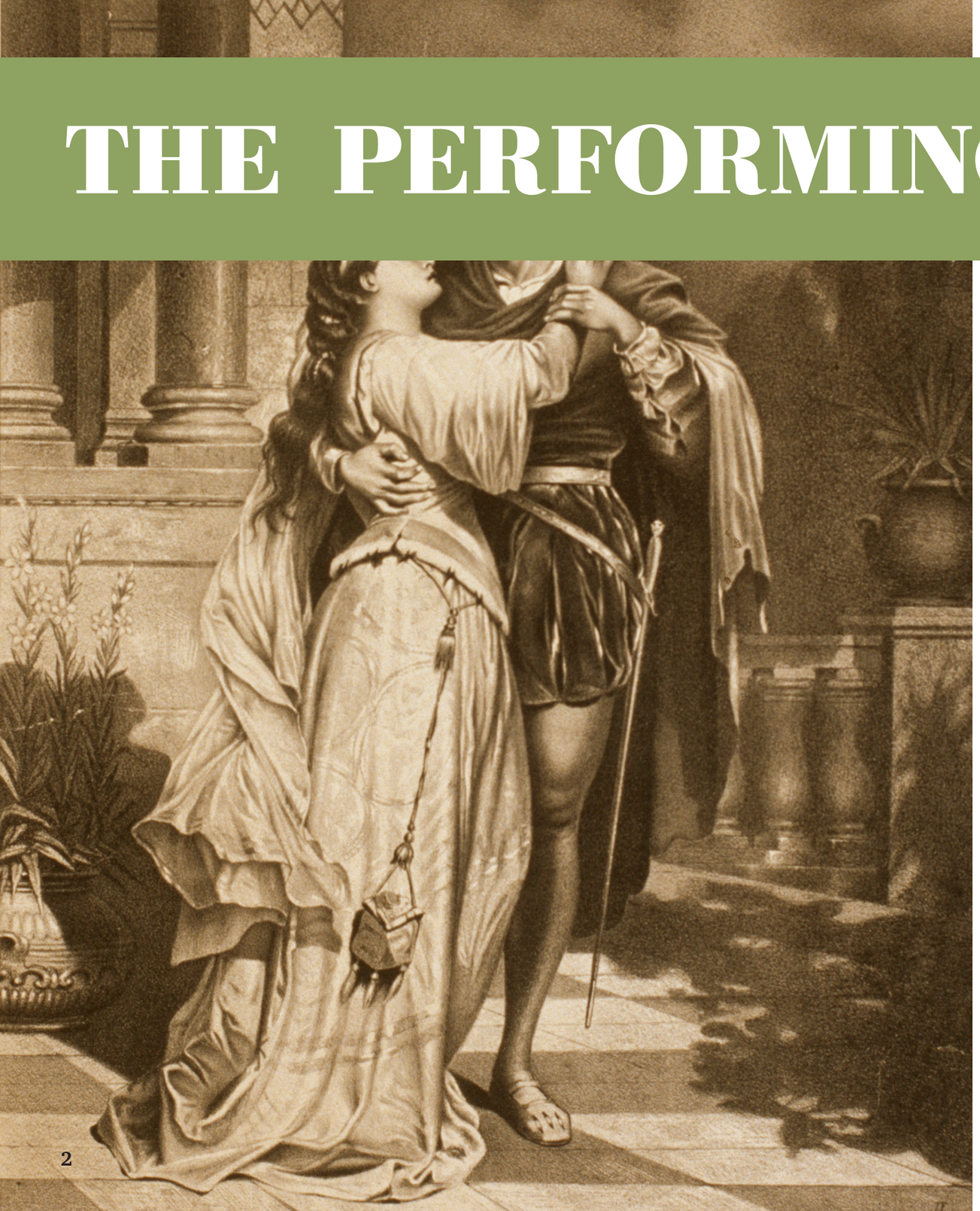
THE PERFORMING ARTS



Organized by Morgan Ash



THE PERFORMING ARTS

Organized By

Morgan Ash

Donors

James Booker
Alyssa Chaney
Andrew Samson
Claire Harden
Erik Vasquez
William Colfer

Credits

Library of Congress

Tidewater Community College

Tour Dates

December 1 – December 30, 2025

INTRODUCTION

The Performing Arts posters illustrate the wide range of popular, live entertainment in America from the late nineteenth to the early twentieth century.
The approximately 2,100 posters in the online Performing Arts Posters category represent the entire contents of three collections: the Magic Poster Collection, the Minstrel Poster Collection, and the Theatrical Poster Collection.

Originally used to attract the public to performances and performers, the posters available through this online assemblage of performing arts posters illustrate the wide range of popular, live entertainment in America from the late nineteenth to the early twentieth century.

The bulk of the posters are color lithographs and woodcuts. Most came to the Library of Congress as copyright deposits. Individual artists are not generally identified on the posters, but many prominent printers of the time produced the posters. Among those well represented in the Performing Arts Posters are:

- The Strobridge Lithograph Company of Cincinnati
- Russell & Morgan Company of Cincinnati and New York
- A.S. Seer of New York
- W.J. Morgan and Company of Cleveland



The sensational comedy-drama taken from life, *Kidnapped in New York* by Howard Hall.
U.S. Printing Company,
Cinti. ; N.Y. : U.S. Printing Co., c1899.
1 print: B&W lithograph; sheet 106 x 70 cm.

Mistakes Will Happen written by Grant Stewart.
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; New York: Strobridge Lith. Co., c1898.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 100 x 75 cm.

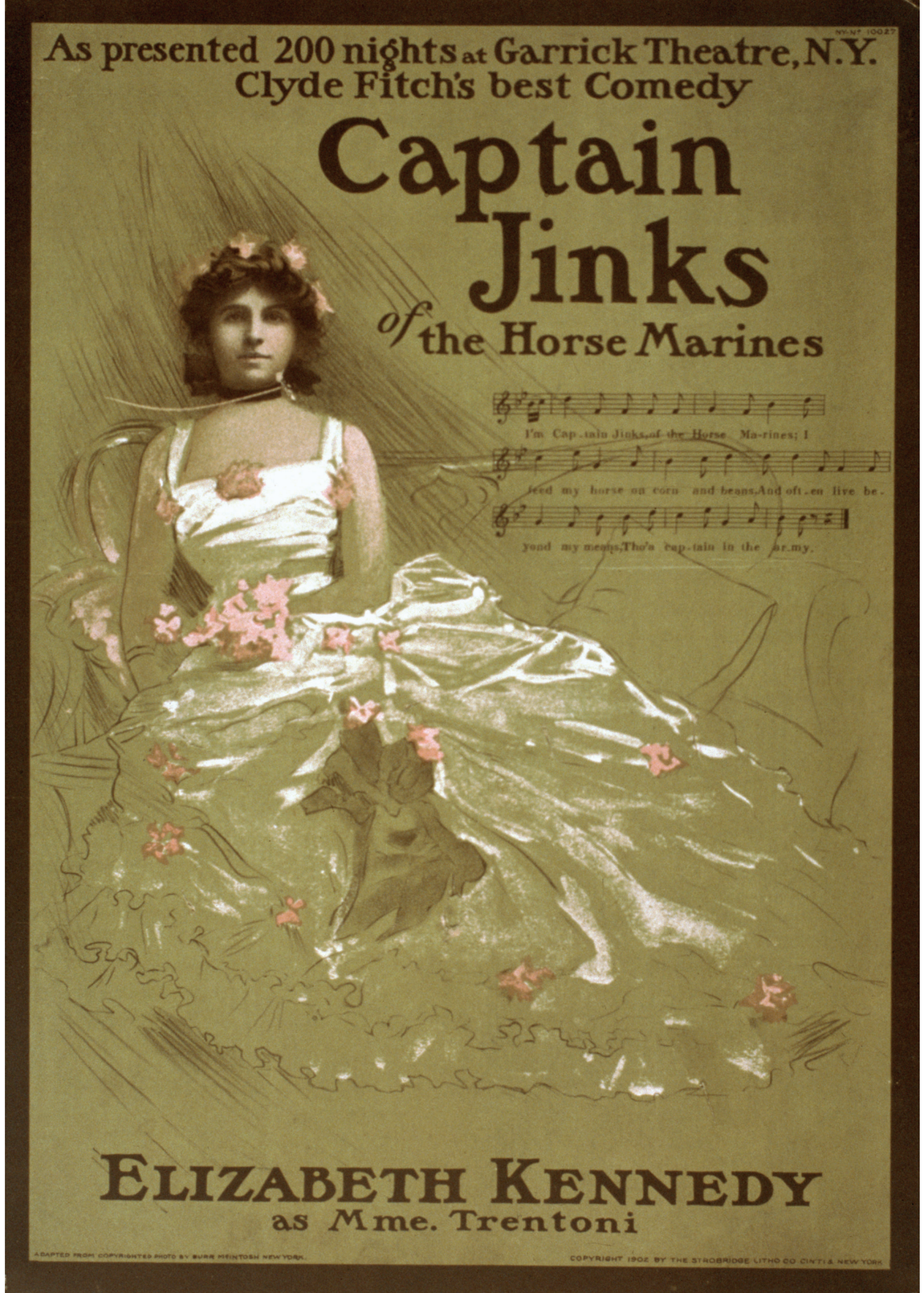


The approximately 2,100 posters in the online Performing Arts Posters category represent the entire contents of three collections, which are discussed in further detail below:

- Magic Poster Collection
- Minstrel Poster Collection
- Theatrical Poster Collection.

Magic Poster Collection
Posters in the Magic Poster Collection feature Harry Houdini, Harry Kellar, Howard Thurston and many other masters of illusion.

Minstrel Poster Collection
The Minstrel Poster Collection highlights individual minstrels and minstrel companies, who usually performed programs of African-American music, broad comedy, and African-American impersonations.
The posters feature portraits as well as depictions of the minstrel performances. While minstrel shows were popular starting in the 1840s, most of the Library of Congress's minstrel posters date from the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, with the exception of an 1847 poster featuring the New Orleans Ethiopian Serenaders.



Theatrical Poster Collection
The Theatrical Poster Collection has been organized into a series of subsets based on the genre of variety stage theater, production company, and poster style or format.

- **Burlesque**
- **Dance**
- **Music**
- **Operetta**
- **Specialty Acts**
- **Vaudeville**

- **Kiralfy Brothers**
The productions of the Kiralfy Brothers, Bolossy and Imre, were the epitome of the stage spectaculars. They incorporated dance, pantomime, and special effects, including one of the earliest uses of electricity on the American stage, into their lavish interpretations of fairy tales, Bible stories, and Jules Verne adventures.

- **Portrait Posters**
Portrait posters bring to life many contemporary stars of the stage.

- **Stock Posters**
Stock posters were designed without a particular show in mind. Generic images of stage scenes were used for the pictorial portion of the poster. Information pertaining to a specific performance could be added to the poster as needed.

Captain Jinks of the Horse Marines as presented 200 nights at Garrick Theatre, N.Y. :
Clyde Fitch's best comedy.
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; New York: Strobridge Lith. Co., c1902.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 45 x 31 cm.

EXHIBITION ITEMS

Originally used to attract the public to performances and performers, the posters available through this online assemblage of performing arts posters illustrate the wide range of popular, live entertainment in America from the late nineteenth to the early twentieth century.
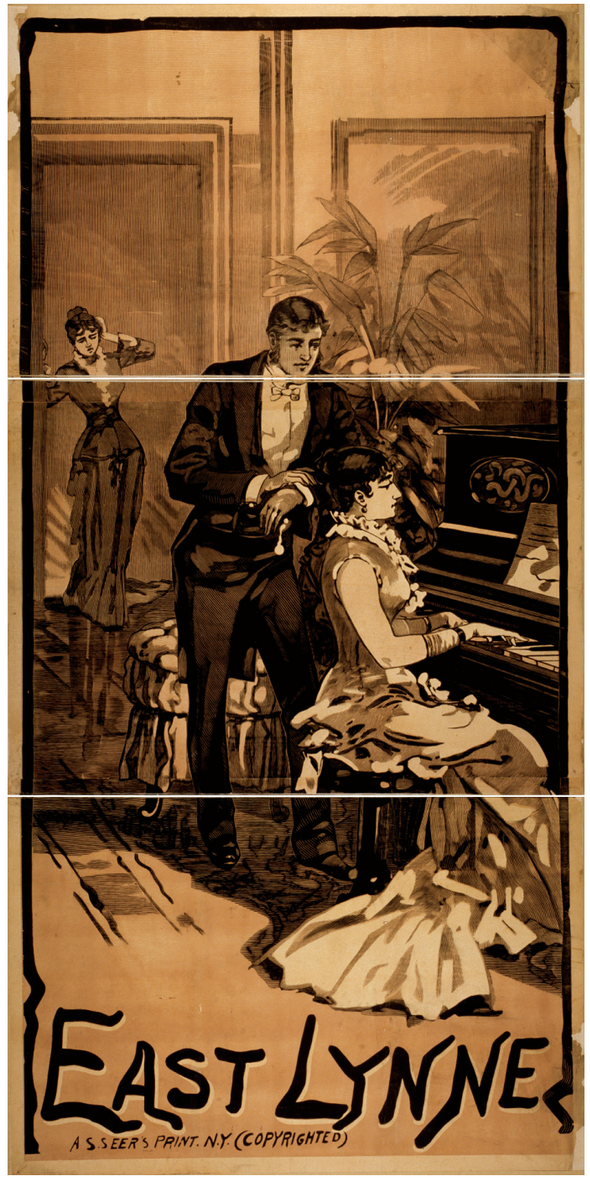


Blaney's latest musical comedy, *A Female Drummer*
H.C. Miner Litho. Co.
N.Y. : H.C. Miner Litho. Co. c1898
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 105 x 70 cm.

Romeo & Juliet
Metropolitan Litho. Studio.,
N.Y. : Metropolitan Litho. Studio, c1879.
1 print: B&W lithograph; sheet 61 x 49 cm.





Emily Bancker in the
screaming comedy, *Our flat*
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; N.Y. : Strobridge Lith. Co., c1895.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 74 x 48 cm.



East Lynne
A.S. Seer Print.,
N.Y. : A.S. Seer's Print, [1881]
1 print: color woodcut; sheet
207 x 105 cm.

Mathews & Bulger presenting rag time opera, *By the Sad Sea Waves*
Strobridge & Co. Lith., Cincinnati; New York: Strobridge Lith. Co., c1898.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 75 x 49 cm.



Devere's High Rollers Burlesque Co.
H.C. Miner Litho. Co.
N.Y. : H.C. Miner Litho. Co., c1898.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 70 x 52 cm.





John Drew's new play, *Rosemary*
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; N.Y. : Strobridge Lith. Co., c1896.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 74 x 48 cm.



The singing comedian, Andrew Mack in
The Last of the Rohans by Ramsay Morris.
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cincinnati; N.Y. : Strobridge Litho. Co., c1899.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 77 x 102 cm.



The Electrician an American comedy drama:
Chas. E. Blaney's greatest success.
H.C. Miner Litho. Co.
N.Y. : H.C. Miner Litho. Co., c1898.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 69 x 104 cm.

CHECKLIST

The sensational comedy-drama taken from life,
Kidnapped in New York by Howard Hall.
U.S. Printing Company,
Cinti. ; N.Y. : U.S. Printing Co., c1899.
1 print: black and white lithograph;
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Mistakes Will Happen written by Grant Stewart.
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Captain Jinks of the Horse Marines as
presented 200 nights at Garrick Theatre,
N.Y. : Clyde Fitch's best comedy.
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; New York: Strobridge Lith. Co., c1902.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 45 x 31 cm.

Blaney's latest musical comedy, *A Female Drummer*
H.C. Miner Litho. Co.
N.Y. : H.C. Miner Litho. Co. c1898
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 105 x 70 cm.

Romeo & Juliet
Metropolitan Litho. Studio.,
N.Y. : Metropolitan Litho. Studio, c1879.
1 print: black and white lithograph;
sheet 61 x 49 cm.

The new musical comedy, *Hotel Topsy Turvy*
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; New York: Strobridge Litho. Co., c1899.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 75 x 101 cm.

Emily Bancker in the screaming comedy, *Our flat*
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; N.Y. : Strobridge Lith. Co., c1895.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 74 x 48 cm.

At Piney Ridge by David Higgins.
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; New York: Strobridge Lith. Co., c1897.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 214 x 102 cm.

East Lynne
A.S. Seer Print.,
N.Y. : A.S. Seer's Print, [1881]
1 print: color woodcut;
sheet 207 x 105 cm.

Mathews & Bulger presenting rag time opera,
By the Sad Sea Waves
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cincinnati; New York: Strobridge Lith. Co., c1898.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 75 x 49 cm.

Devere's High Rollers Burlesque Co.
H.C. Miner Litho. Co.
N.Y. : H.C. Miner Litho. Co., c1898.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 70 x 52 cm.

John Drew's new play, *Rosemary*
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; N.Y. : Strobridge Lith. Co., c1896.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 74 x 48 cm.

Martha Perkins in *Way Down East*
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; New York: Strobridge Lith. Co., c1898.
1 print: black and white litho-
graph; sheet 46 x 22 cm.

The singing comedian, Andrew Mack in
The Last of the Rohans by Ramsay Morris.
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cincinnati; N.Y. : Strobridge Litho. Co., c1899.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 77 x 102 cm.

The Woman in Black by H. Grattan Donnelly.
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cincinnati; New York: Strobridge Lith. Co., c1896.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 280 x 196 cm.

Hoyt's *A Contented Woman*
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; N.Y. : Strobridge Lith. Co., c1895.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 76 x 100 cm.

The Electrician an American comedy drama:
Chas. E. Blaney's greatest success.
H.C. Miner Litho. Co.
N.Y. : H.C. Miner Litho. Co., c1898.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 69 x 104 cm.

Emily Bancker in *A Divorce Cure* from the
French of Sardou by Harry Saint Maur.
Strobridge & Co. Lith.,
Cinti; New York: Strobridge Lith. Co., c1897.
1 print: color lithograph; sheet 77 x 101 cm.

Sponsors

Kevin Mclean

Aamir Austin

Aleesha Watkins

Sadie Montoya

Fabio Boyer

Awais Gibbs

Kelsey Stewart

Curtis Holloway

Elouise Beasley

Miguel Elliott